Republic of Korea (South Korea).

With the end of the Cold War, the strategic context for UN peacekeeping dramatically changed, prompting the UN to shift and expand its field operations from 'traditional' missions involving strictly military tasks, to complex 'multidimensional' enterprises designed to ensure the implementation of comprehensive peace agreements and assist in laying the foundations for sustainable peace. Today's peacekeepers undertake a wide variety of complex tasks, from helping to build sustainable institutions of governance, to human rights monitoring, to security sector reform, to the disarmament, demobilization and reintegration of former combatants.

But the nature of peacekeeping has been changing over time, especially after the end of the Cold War. Previously, such UN peacekeeping operations were seen as a means of resolving the conflicts involving states by deploying unarmed or lightly armed military personnel from a number of countries with the consent of the warring parties to keep peace between the armed forces when a ceasefire was in place and to monitor the implementation of the peace agreements. But since the end of the Cold War, peacekeeping has become more complex and now operations involve more non-military elements such as police officers and civilian personnel to perform wide functions beyond assisting ex-combatants in implementing peace agreements, DDRR (Disarmament, Demobilization, Reintegration and Rehabilitation), confidence-building measures, power-sharing arrangements, electoral support, strengthening of the rule of law, and economic and social development.

UN peacekeeping continues to evolve, both conceptually and operationally, to meet new challenges and political realities. Faced with the rising demand for increasingly complex peace operations, the United Nations in the past few years has been overstretched and challenged as never before. The Organization has worked vigorously to strengthen its capacity to manage and sustain field operations and, thus, contributes to the most important function of the United Nations to maintain international peace and security.

UN Department of Peacekeeping Operations